

University of Groningen
Faculty of Economics & Business
EBB908B10 – Bachelor's Thesis E&BE
Academic Year 2025 – 2026

TEMPLATE FOR MANDATORY AI DISCLOSURE STATEMENT

Instructions: Please use this template to structure the mandatory AI disclosure statement for your bachelor thesis. Fill in the table below and then add a short paragraph explaining how academic integrity and originality were ensured throughout the thesis process. For stages where no AI tools were used, indicate “Not used” in the “AI tool(s) used” column.

AI Disclosure by Stage of the Thesis Development Process			
Stage of the thesis	AI tool(s) used	Purpose of use	Critical reflection on AI output
<i>Brainstorming</i>	Claude Opus 4.7	Feedback loop with the prompt “what am I missing on”	This way of using AI as an independent assessor and mentor has showed great specifically when you prompt it to find gaps in your ideas, result is sharper ideas from me.
<i>Literature Review</i>	Claude Opus 4.7 and 4.8	Checking of correct interpretation of academic papers	Output for this use case works well, it provides me with feedback and lets me make the decision to see whether I change it or not.
<i>Research question Formulation</i>	Not used		
<i>Research Problem Motivation</i>	Claude Opus 4.8	Second reader.	Works well as a second critical reader, especially if you encourage it to, it can be very harsh (for the better).
<i>Methodology</i>	Claude Opus 4.8	Discussing the experimental design, I came up with.	Again, with prompting it to “spot the gaps”, “is this stupid?”, “what am I missing”. It has worked great as a discussion partner

<i>Data Analysis</i>	Claude Opus 4.8	Coding support for C++ and Python.	Since I designed it from Day 0 to have safe rails in data (those cross patterns at 0 being the same as the baseline) I had no trouble with AI output here.
<i>Discussion of Results</i>	Claude Opus 4.8	Used prompt “Is this interpretation of mine defensible?”	Prompt worked well.
<i>Writing Process</i>	Claude Opus 4.7 and 4.8, GPT-5.5	Helped to spot clarity issues and with LaTeX compilation issues.	Very good at fixing latex errors.
<i>Referencing</i>	Not used		

Include below a Reflection on Academic Integrity and Originality:

Throughout the thesis I treated AI tools as an assistant to make me sharper. I primarily used AI to help me code, in the end it's around 12 000 lines of code and for those who have written C++ they know how painful the debugging is, this engineering challenge has little to do with originality, as that's not the main outcome of a BSc Economics thesis. I drafted the text before seeking AI feedback, and I rejected or rewrote any suggestion that would have altered the arguments I came up with. Every cited source was found and read by me and no claim in the thesis rests on AI output that I had not verified.